

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

THE AILING PLANET: THE GREEN MOVEMENT'S ROLE

LECTURE- 02

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

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Summary and Textual Question

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The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

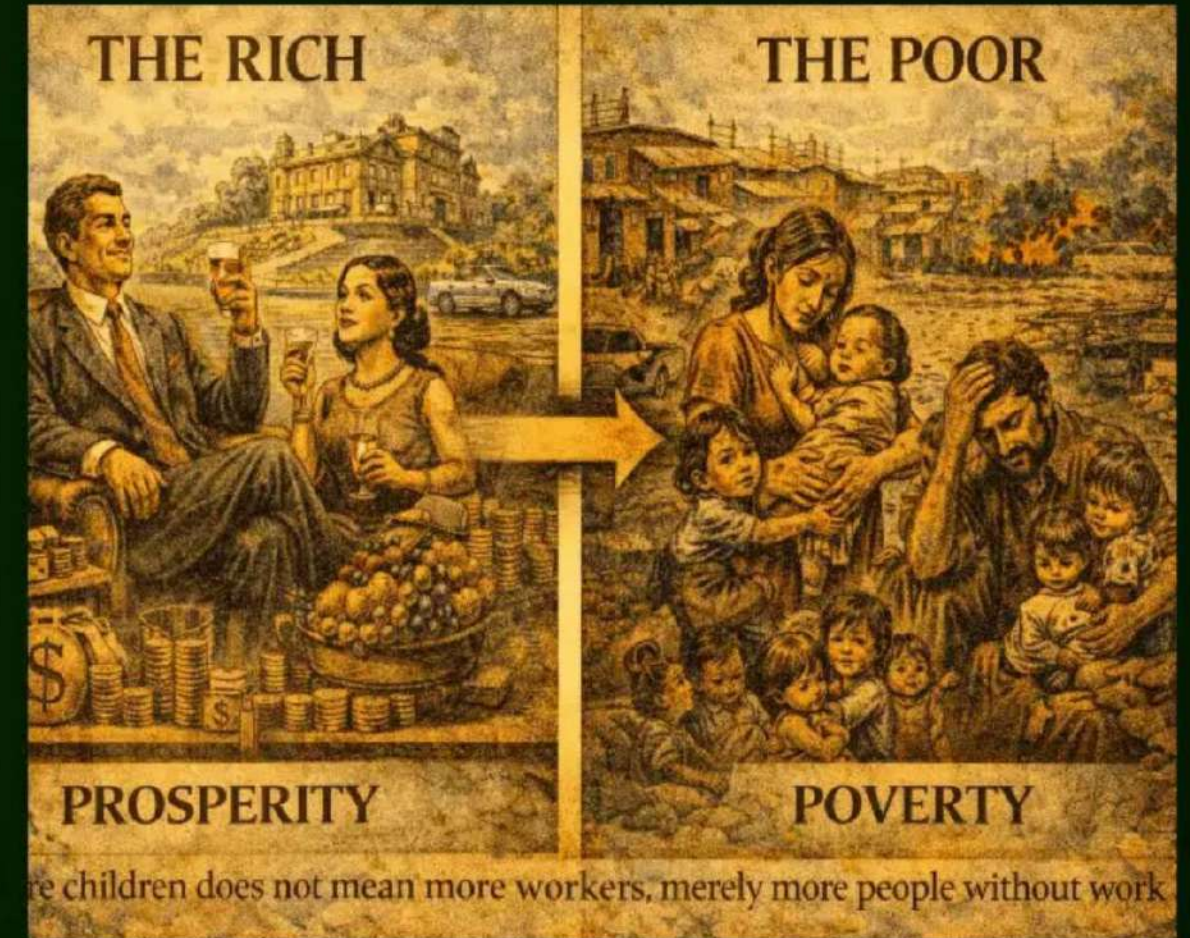
Fertility falls as incomes rise, education spreads, and health improves. Thus development is the best contraceptive. But development itself may not be possible if the present increase in numbers continues.



The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

The rich get richer, and the poor beget children which condemns them to remain poor. More children does not mean more workers, merely more people without work. It is not suggested that human beings be treated like cattle and compulsorily sterilised.

Sterilised: To prevent reproduction (stop someone from having children)



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But there is no alternative to voluntary family planning without introducing an element of coercion. The choice is really between control of population and perpetuation of poverty.

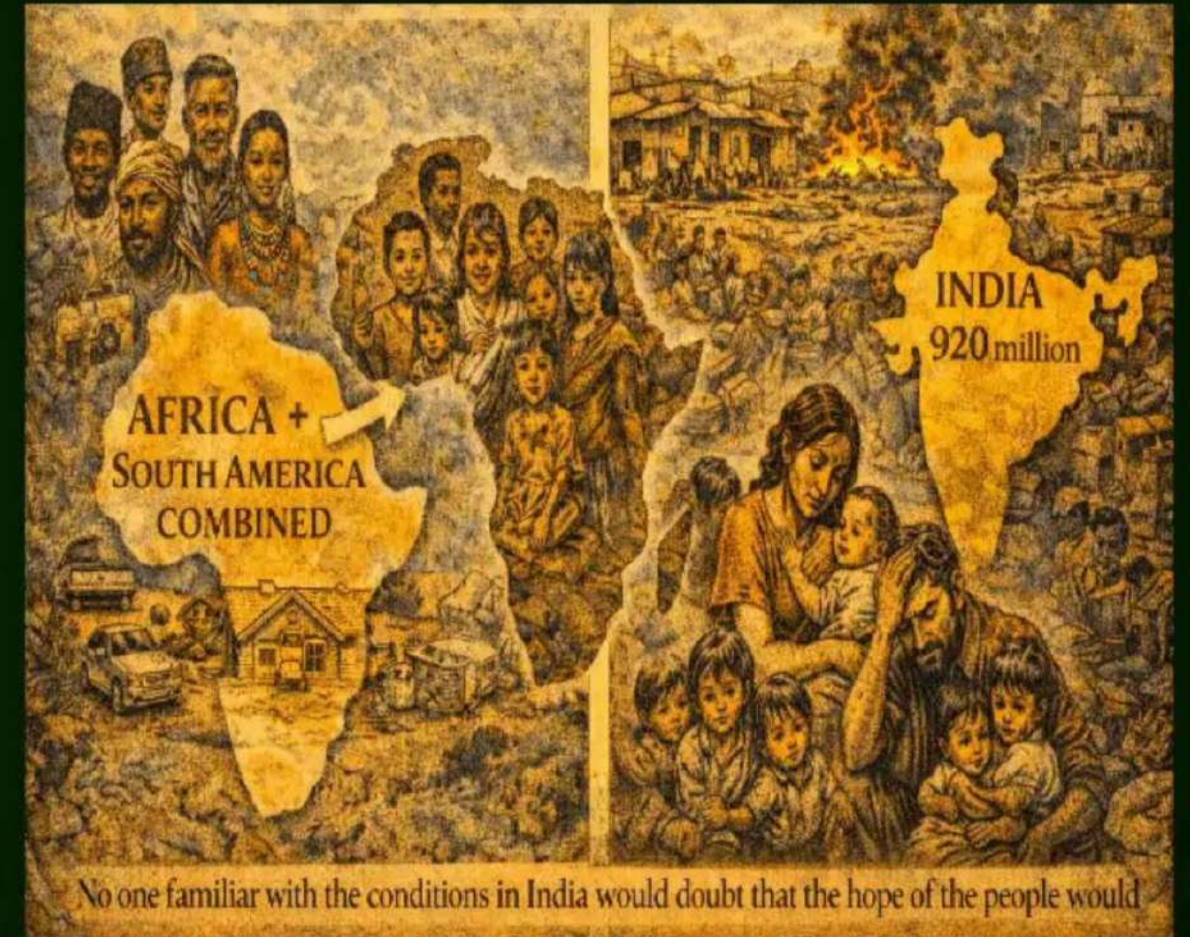
Coercion: force

Perpetuation: Keeping something going forever, often something bad.



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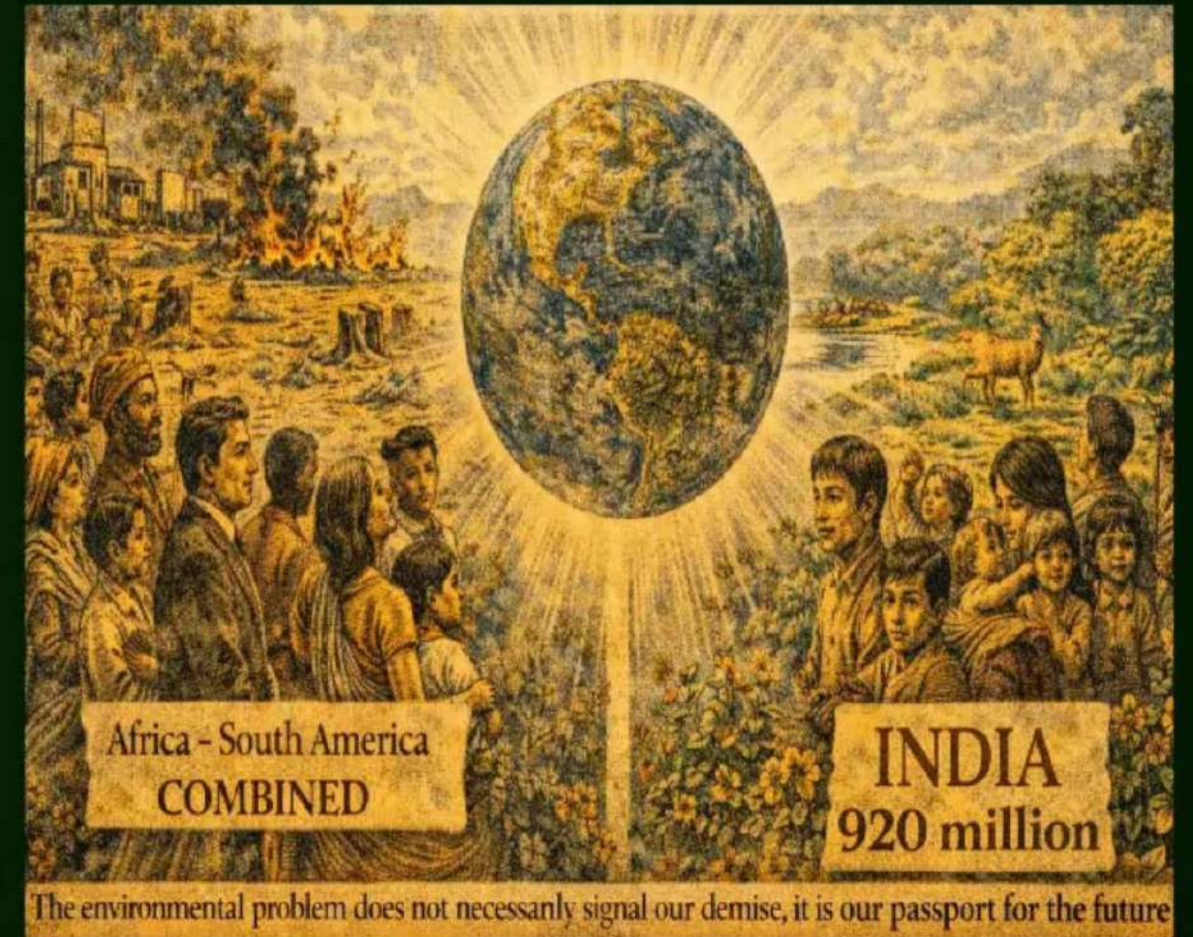
The population of India is estimated to be *1.467 Billion* 920 million today — more than the entire populations of Africa and South America put together. No one familiar with the conditions in India would doubt that the hope of the people would die in their hungry hutments unless population control is given topmost priority.



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For the first time in human history we see a transcending concern — the survival not just of the people but of the planet. We have begun to take a holistic view of the very basis of our existence. The environmental problem does not necessarily signal our demise, it is our passport for the future.

Transcending concern: a concern that existed for a very long time & has passed down from one generation to another

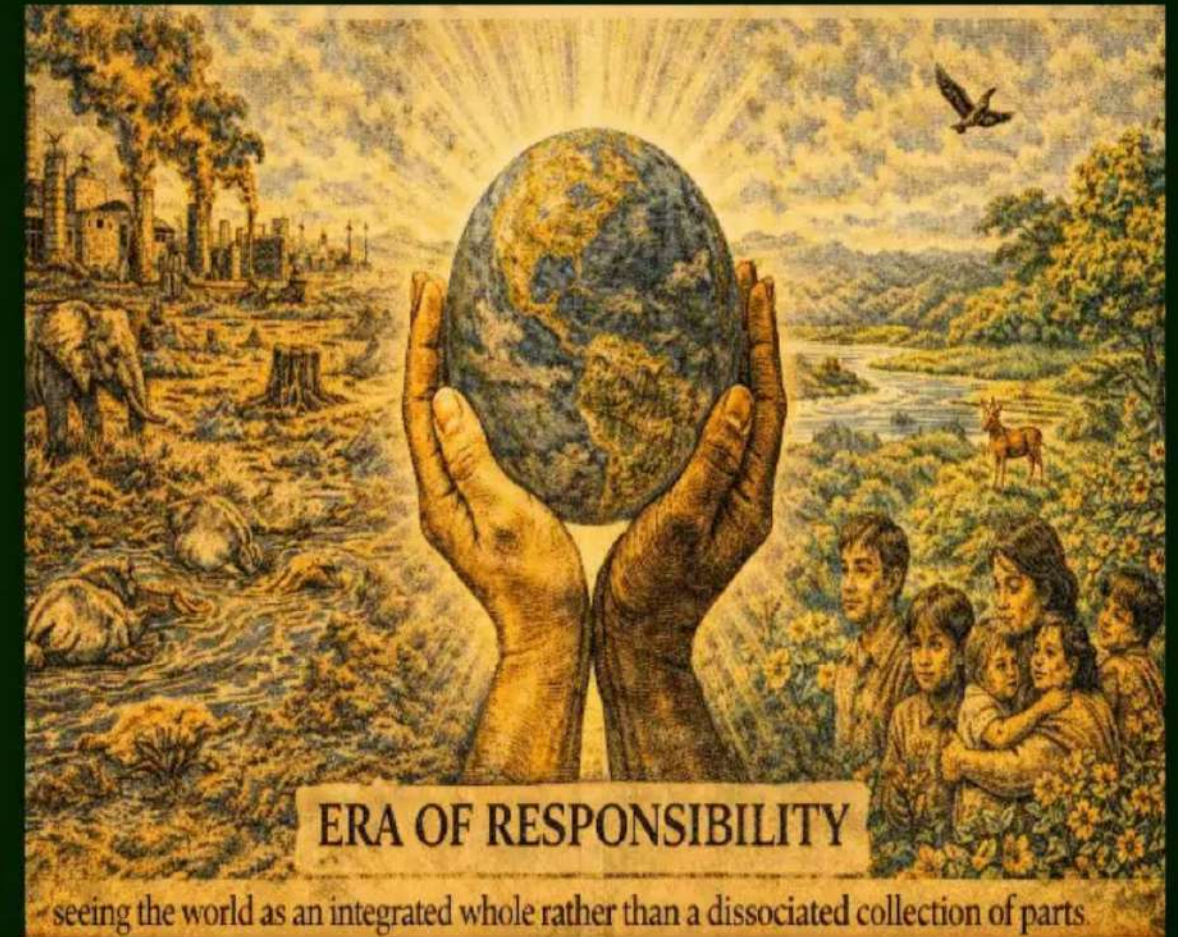


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The emerging new world vision has ushered in the Era of Responsibility. It is a holistic view, an ecological view, seeing the world as an integrated whole rather than a dissociated collection of parts.

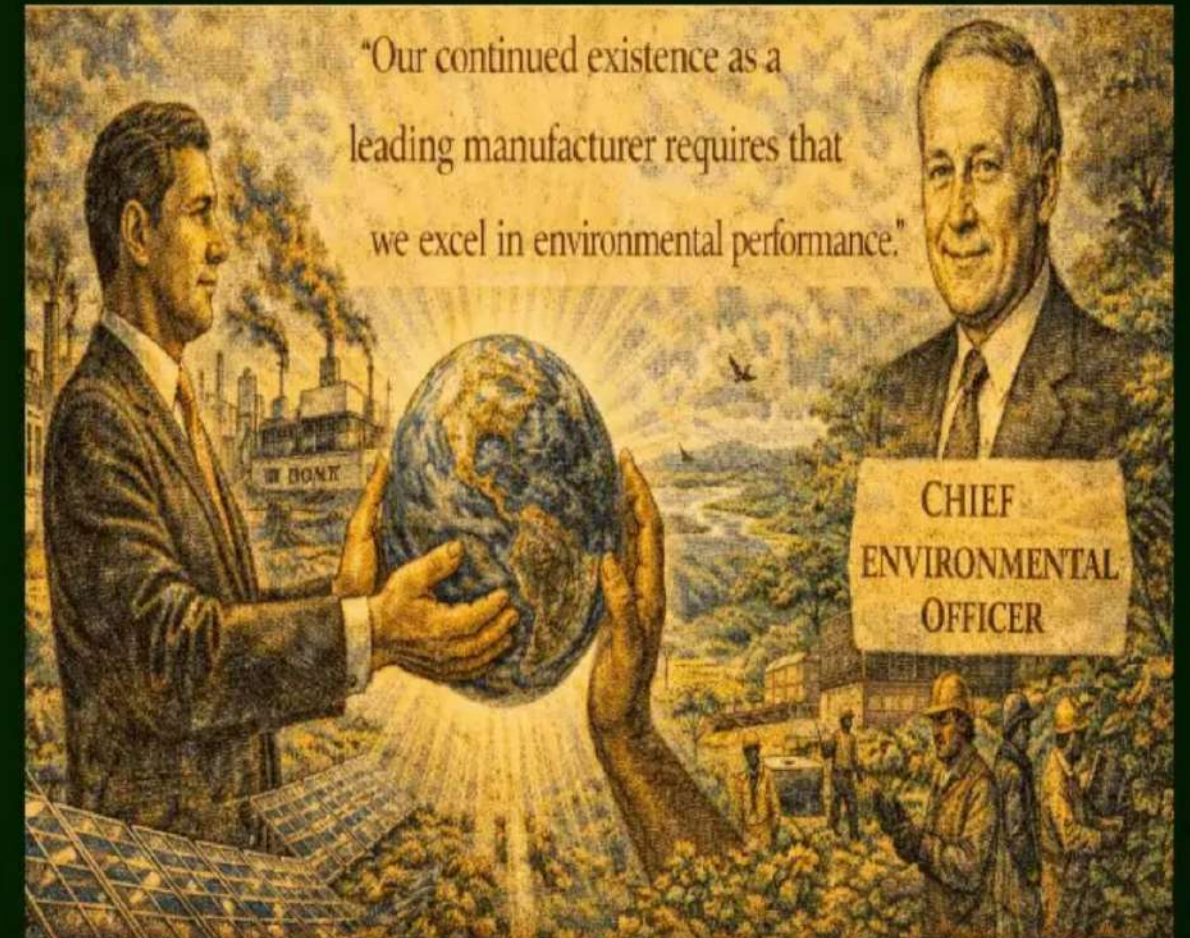
Ushered: guided someone somewhere

Dissociated: disconnected



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Industry has a most crucial role to play in this new Era of Responsibility. What a transformation would be effected if more businessmen shared the view of the Chairman of Du Pont, Mr Edgar S. Woolard who, five years ago, declared himself to be the Company's "Chief Environmental Officer" . He said, "Our continued existence as a leading manufacturer requires that we excel in environmental performance."



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Of all the statements made by Margaret Thatcher during the years of her Prime Ministership, none has passed so decisively into the current coin of English usage as her felicitous words: “No generation has a freehold on this earth.”

Decisively: clearly and definitive

Felicitous: well chosen

Freehold: permanent

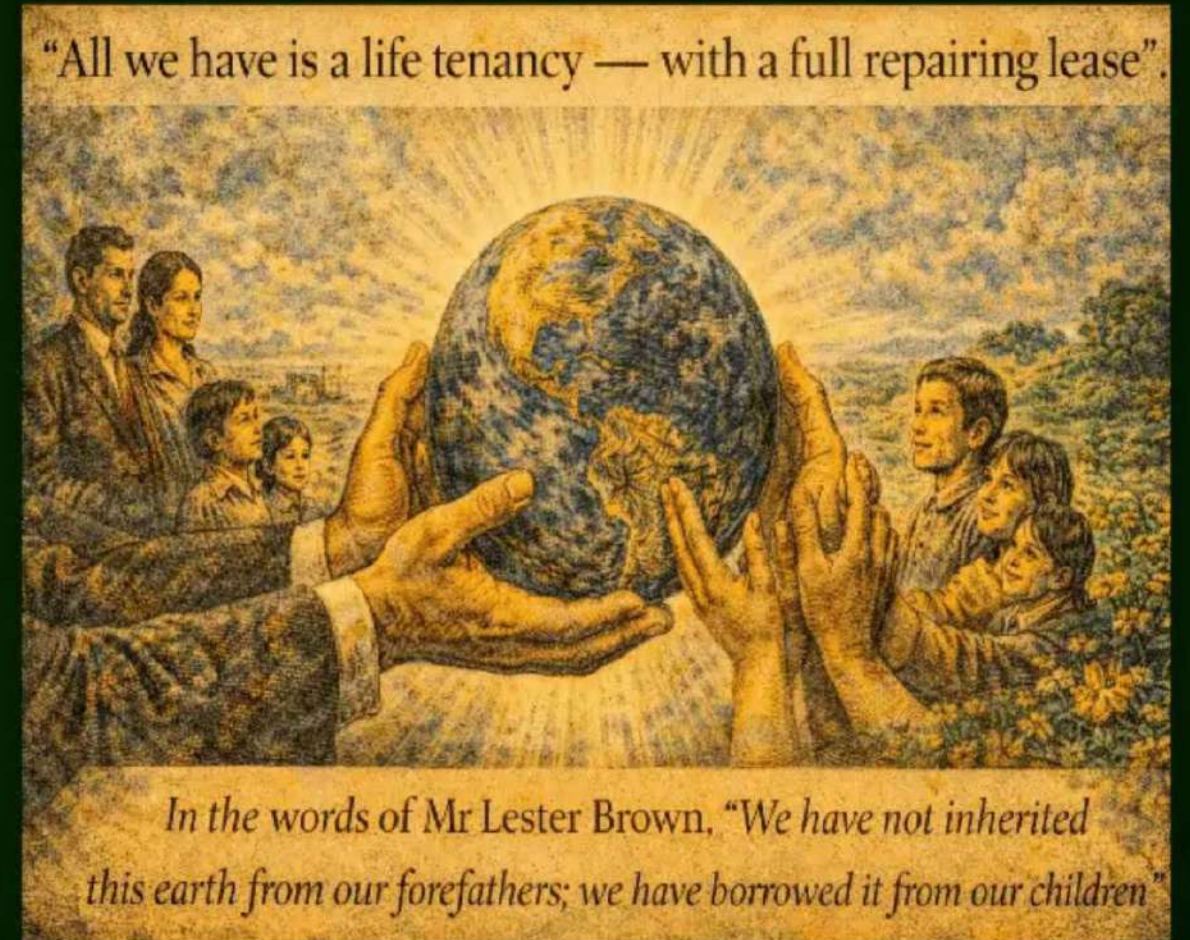


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All we have is a life tenancy — with a full repairing lease .

In the words of Mr Lester Brown, “We have not inherited this earth from our forefathers; we have borrowed it from our children.”

Tenancy: living on or using someone else's land or house by paying rent.



“All we have is a life tenancy — with a full repairing lease”.

In the words of Mr Lester Brown, “We have not inherited this earth from our forefathers; we have borrowed it from our children”

QUESTION

Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a major biological system of the Earth?

- 1 Forests
- 2 Agriculture
- 3 Water bodies
- 4 Grasslands

QUESTION



What shift in human perception does the author mention?

- 1 From military power to financial strength
- 2 ~~From ownership of land to trusteeship of the Earth~~
- 3 From agriculture to industry
- 4 From conservation to exploitation

QUESTION



What is the significance of the Green Movement according to the author?

- 1 It promotes industrial growth
- 2 It emphasizes humanity's relationship with nature
- 3 It supports economic liberalization
- 4 It discourages education

QUESTION



What does the World Bank define as the 'most crucial concern'?

- 1 Pollution control 
- 2 Economic development
- 3 Development without destruction
- 4 Nuclear energy

QUESTION



Who said: “We have not inherited this Earth from our forefathers; we have borrowed it from our children”?

- 1 Mahatma Gandhi
- 2 Lester Brown ~~XXXX~~
- 3 NaniPalkhivala
- 4 A Green Movement leader

QUESTION



What role does man need to play, as per the author?

- 1 Ruler of nature
- 2 Exploiter of natural resources
- 3 Trustee of the Earth
- 4 Destroyer of wildlife

The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role

Nani Palkhivala

(SUMMARY)



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The Beginning of the Green Movement

The essay opens by saying that a revolutionary change came in 1972. It was in that year that the Green Movement began and gave a new direction to human thinking all over the world. Before this, people thought that the Earth and its resources could be used without limit. But in 1972, people began to realize that the Earth's resources were not infinite and must be protected.



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The Beginning of the Green Movement

This movement started the idea that man and nature are not enemies but partners in survival. It awakened the human race to the danger of destroying its own home — the planet Earth.



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A Change in Human Attitude

Palkhivala says that a great change has come in the way people think. For a long time, human beings believed they were masters of nature, who could rule, exploit, and control it. But now people have understood that they are not the owners of this planet; they are only a part of it. If we destroy nature, we destroy ourselves.



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A Change in Human Attitude

This change in attitude — from dominance to coexistence — is described as the “Green Revolution of the human spirit.” It is more important than any scientific or industrial revolution because it changes how we think about life itself.



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The Earth as a Living Organism

Now, scientists see the Earth as a living organism. It has its own systems that help it survive. But because of human greed and misuse of resources, the Earth is now ailing—that is, sick.

Palkhivala calls our planet “The Ailing Planet” because it is suffering due to the damage caused by humans. The environment, forests, animals, and rivers are all crying for help. The Green Movement tries to heal the planet before it becomes too late.



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The United Nations Report

The author then refers to a report of the United Nations. This report was a warning to mankind. It said that the condition of the Earth is very poor and that the planet's ability to support life is being destroyed. The report clearly mentions that the human population has grown too much and that the demands on Earth are much more than it can supply. The report made it clear that the Earth is not just a storehouse of resources—it is a living system that must be cared for and respected.



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The Concept of Sustainable Development

Palkhivala then explains that the future of humanity depends on sustainable development. He defines it as development that meets the needs of the present without harming the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

This means we must not use all our resources now and leave nothing for our children and grandchildren. We should live within our means and respect the limits of nature.



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The Four Biological Systems

The author says that all life on Earth depends on four main biological systems:

1. **Fisheries** (marine life)
2. **Forests** (trees and plants)
3. **Grasslands** (for grazing animals)
4. **Croplands** (for growing food)



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The Four Biological Systems

These four systems are the foundation of our survival, as they provide us with food, raw materials, and other essential things. But human activity has put all these systems under great stress. If they collapse, life on Earth will be impossible.



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Overfishing

Palkhivala explains that the first biological system, fisheries, is being overused. People are catching fish faster than fish can reproduce. As a result, the population of fish is decreasing at an alarming rate.

He mentions that many fishing industries now catch young fish before they have grown and reproduced. This practice threatens to destroy the entire marine ecosystem.



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Deforestation

The second biological system, forests, is in even greater danger. Trees are being cut down everywhere to provide fuel, timber, and land for cultivation.

When forests disappear, rainfall becomes irregular, soil is eroded, and the air becomes polluted. Forests are called the “lungs of the Earth” because they produce oxygen and absorb carbon dioxide. But by cutting down forests, we are making the planet suffocate.



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Deforestation

The author mentions that in many developing countries, including India, poor villagers cut trees for firewood because they have no other source of energy. This causes serious damage to the environment.



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Overgrazing and Loss of Grasslands

The third biological system, grasslands, is also in danger. These areas are meant to feed cattle and other animals. But because the number of animals has increased, the grass is being eaten faster than it can grow again.

Overgrazing makes fertile land turn into desert. When this happens, animals have nothing left to eat, and people lose their means of livelihood.

Thus, human greed and population pressure have destroyed the balance of nature.



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Damage to Croplands

The fourth system, croplands, is where we grow our food. But these lands are becoming less fertile because of overuse. Farmers use chemical fertilizers and pesticides to increase crop production.

At first, this seems helpful, but slowly, these chemicals destroy the fertility of the soil. They also pollute rivers and underground water.

In short, by trying to grow more food to feed our growing population, we are poisoning our land and water.



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The Earth's Carrying Capacity

Palkhivala explains that the Earth has a limited carrying capacity. It can only support a certain number of people and animals. But the human population is growing so fast that the planet cannot bear the pressure.

He warns that if population growth is not controlled, the Earth will not be able to provide food, water, and shelter for everyone.

He uses the example of India, where the population increases by about 15.5 million every year — equal to the entire population of Australia. This puts a terrible strain on all resources.



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The Population Explosion

The author calls this uncontrolled growth a Population Explosion. He says that developing countries like India and China suffer the most from it. More people mean more demand for food, housing, water, and energy — and this demand leads to more pollution, deforestation, and exploitation of nature. He points out that population control is not only necessary for economic progress but also for environmental survival.



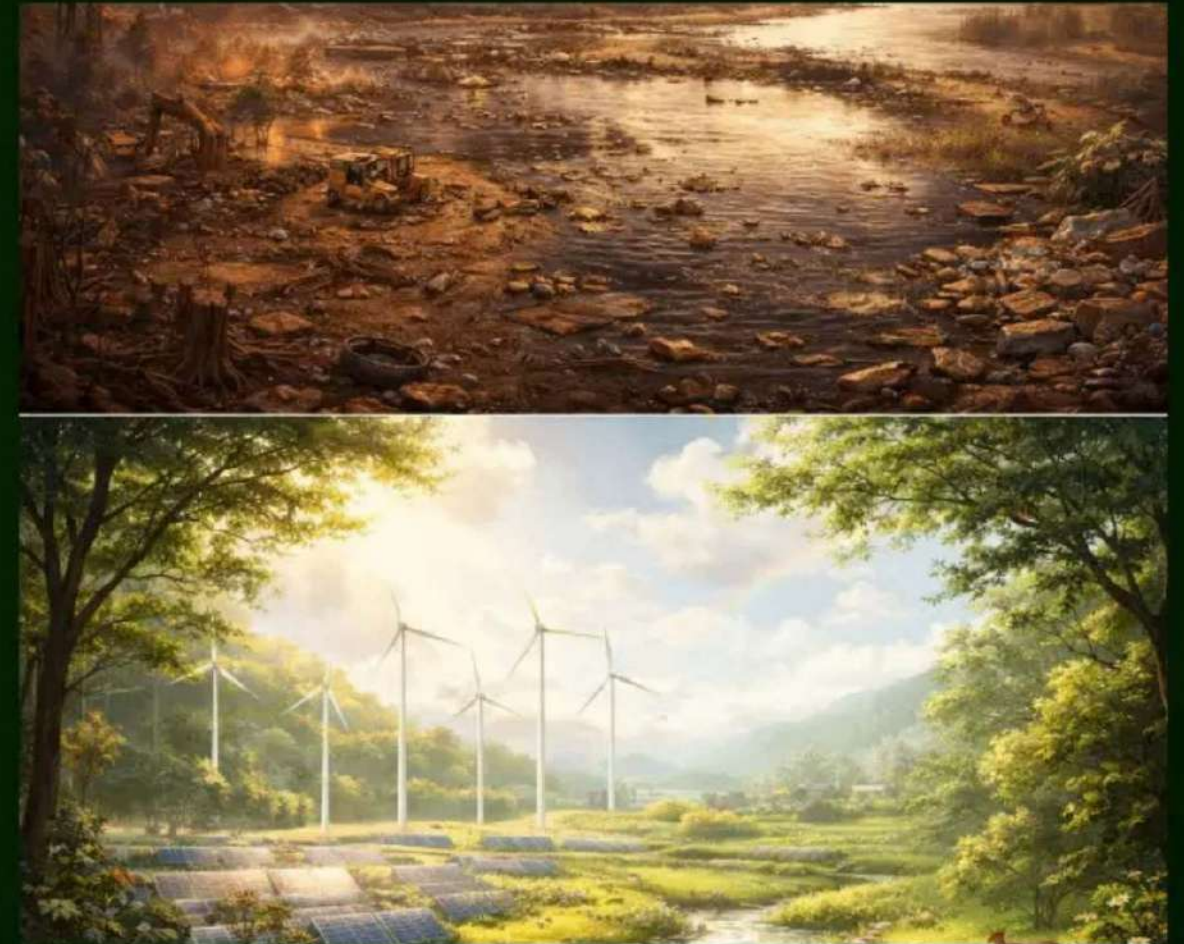
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The Question of Development

Some people think that development means having more factories, roads, and machines. But Palkhivala argues that real development is something else.

True development means growth with balance — it means using resources in a way that benefits both the present and future generations.

He emphasizes that we must have sustainable development, not blind industrial growth that destroys forests, pollutes the air, and kills rivers.



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The Role of the Government

The author praises India for being the first country in the world to make environmental protection a part of its Constitution.

According to Article 48A, the State must protect and improve the environment and safeguard forests and wildlife.

However, he also says that although we have good laws, they are often not followed. Many people, companies, and even government agencies ignore them.

He stresses that laws alone cannot help unless people also change their attitude.



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The Idea of Trusteeship

Palkhivala then says that we are only trustees of this planet, not its owners.

This idea was inspired by Mahatma Gandhi, who believed that the world has enough for everyone's need but not for everyone's greed.

As trustees, it is our duty to take care of the Earth and pass it on to the next generation in a healthy condition.

If we continue to misuse it, we are stealing the future of our children.



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The Responsibility of Each Individual

The author explains that protecting the planet is not just the duty of the government — every person must play their part.

He says that people must be educated about the environment. They must realize that small changes, like planting trees, saving water, or avoiding plastic, can make a big difference.

If every individual acts responsibly, the Earth can recover and heal.



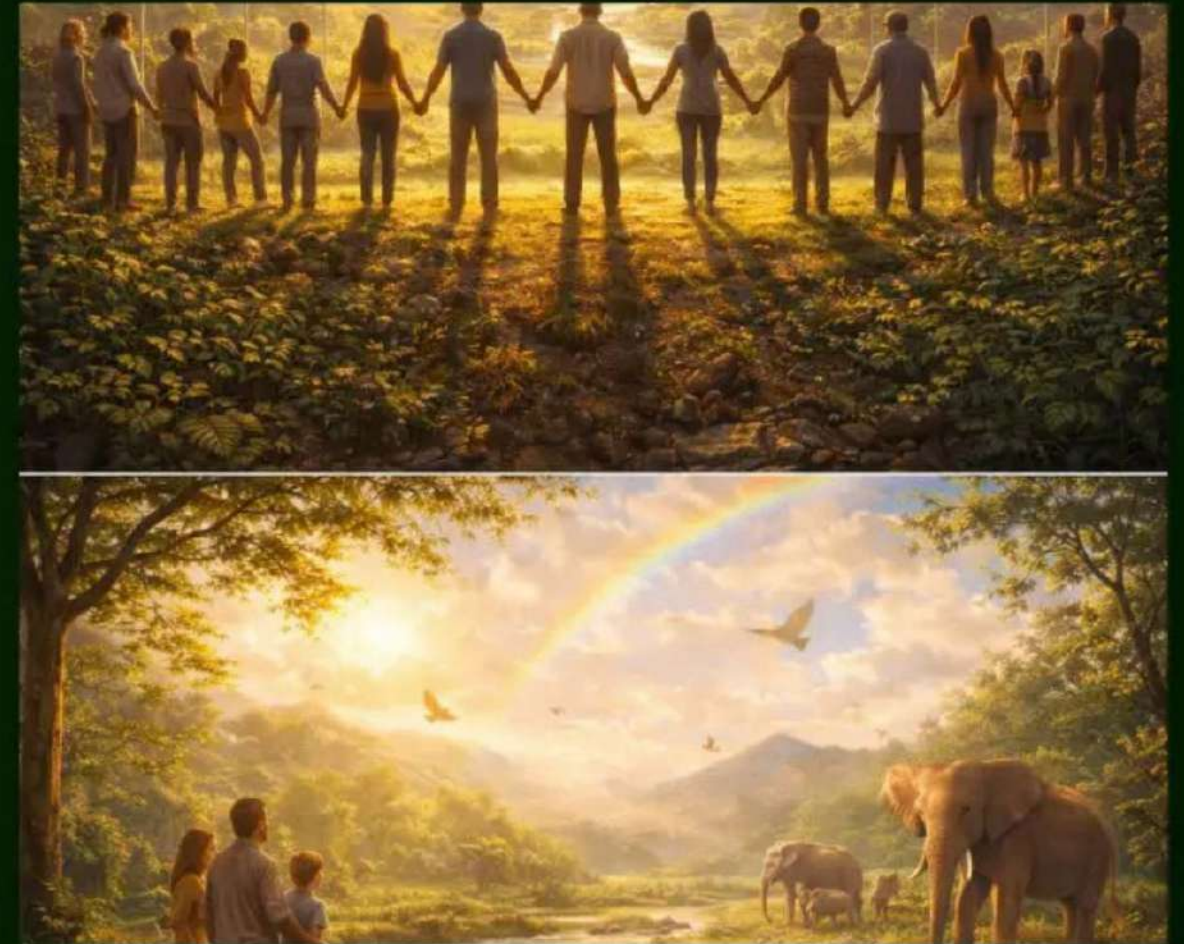
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Hope for the Future

Finally, Nani Palkhivala ends his essay with a message of hope.

He believes that although the situation is serious, it is not hopeless. If human beings realize their mistakes and change their behavior, the planet can still be saved.

He urges all nations — rich and poor — to come together and work for the common good of the Earth. He dreams of a future where human beings live in harmony with nature, respecting all forms of life.



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Conclusion

Nani Palkhivala's "The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role" is a strong warning to mankind.

It reminds us that the Earth is a living organism that is becoming sick.

Human greed and overpopulation are destroying forests, rivers, and wildlife.

The four biological systems — fisheries, forests, grasslands, and croplands — are in great danger.



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Conclusion

Development must be sustainable.
We are trustees of this planet, not its owners.
The essay calls for a change in human attitude — from exploitation to protection — so that future generations can inherit a healthy, green, and living planet.



QUESTION



Locate the lines in the text that support the title ‘The Ailing Planet’

ANSWER:

The lines that support the title are: “The Earth’s vital signs reveal a patient in declining health.” “It is a grim reminder of the changing perception — from mechanistic to holistic view of the world.” These lines show that the planet is suffering due to human exploitation, much like a sick patient who needs urgent care

QUESTION



What does the notice 'The world's most dangerous animal' at a cage in the zoo at Lusaka, Zambia, signify?

ANSWER:

The notice refers to humans as the most dangerous animal. The cage has only a mirror inside it. This is a symbolic way to show that human beings are responsible for the destruction of the environment, and unless they change, they will continue harming the planet.

QUESTION



How are the Earth's principal biological systems being depleted?

ANSWER:

The Earth's four biological systems — fisheries, forests, grasslands, and croplands — are being depleted due to overuse and misuse. Overfishing, deforestation, overgrazing, and excessive farming are exhausting these systems and reducing their capacity to regenerate.

QUESTION



Why is tropical forest called the powerhouse of evolution?

ANSWER:

Tropical forests are called the powerhouse of evolution because they are home to a vast variety of plants and animals. These forests support biodiversity and are a crucial part of the Earth's ecological system, promoting life and evolutionary processes.

QUESTION



Why does the author aver that growth of the world population is one of the strongest factors distorting the future of human society?

ANSWER:

The author stresses that without population control, all efforts to protect the environment and ensure sustainable development will fail. Thus, it is crucial to address population growth to secure a better and balanced future for humanity.

Thank
You